

Siyoung Lee

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EDUCATION

Sogang University, Republic of Korea
M.A. in Economics (in progress, GPA: 4.30/4.30)

Sep 2025–Present

Sogang University, Republic of Korea
B.A. in Economics (GPA: 4.27/4.30)
B.S. in Mathematics (GPA: 4.05/4.30)

Aug 2025

- Ranked 1st in the School of Economics (out of 63 graduates)
- Graduated early, completing both degrees in seven semesters
- Honors in Economic Theory

FIELDS OF INTEREST

International Finance, Spatial Economics, Macroeconomics, Econometrics

WORKING PAPERS

”The Geography of Interest Rate Differences”

(with Junhee Kwak, * **First author**)

- Abstract: Documents that cross-country interest-rate differences increase systematically with geographic distance. Develops a structural portfolio-choice model in which geography affects capital allocation through bilateral distance frictions and spatially correlated destination characteristics. Estimates the model using bilateral portfolio holdings and cross-country interest-rate data, and quantifies the contribution of each geographic channel to interest-rate dispersion.

”Sensitivity Analysis in Sharp Regression Discontinuity Designs”

(with Sungwon Lee, Sukyung Joo and Beomsu Kim)

- Abstract: Develops a partial-identification framework for extrapolating causal effects beyond the cutoff in sharp regression discontinuity designs. Derives sharp bounds on average and distributional treatment effects under smoothness restrictions on potential outcome distributions, parameterized by interpretable sensitivity measures. Demonstrates the method through Monte Carlo simulations and an empirical application on external validity.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Project “*Revisiting the Fertility Puzzle: A Dynamic Spatial Equilibrium Approach*”

May 2025–Present

Co-PIs: **Costas Arkolakis (Yale)**, **Junhee Kwak (Sogang)**, **Hyunjoo Yang (Sogang)**

- Designed and implemented the model’s structural estimation strategy, including analytical derivations for parameter identification and estimation.
- Constructed and integrated extensive administrative, financial, telecommunications, and geographic datasets.
- Validated proprietary big-data sources against administrative records and conducted reduced-form analyses across multiple levels of geographic aggregation.

Research Assistant for **Prof. Junhee Kwak (Sogang)**

Mar 2025–July 2025

WORK IN PROGRESS

”A Spatial Theory of Exchange Rate Disconnect”

- Develops a multi-country model of exchange rates to study how geographic frictions shape the cross-country transmission of financial shocks.

PRESENTATIONS

Sensitivity Analysis in Sharp Regression Discontinuity Designs

- The International Symposium on Econometric Theory and Applications, Tokyo, Japan June 2026
- KER International Conference, Jeju, Republic of Korea June 2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant for Prof. Younghoon Lee

- Econometrics, Economic Statistics

Tutor, Economics Study Center, Sogang Univ

- Econometrics, Advanced Econometrics, Applied Econometrics, Economic Statistics

SCHOLARSHIPS / FELLOWSHIPS

Albatross Fellowship, Sogang Univ · Sep 2025- Present

Brain Korea 21-Four Fellowship, Sogang Univ · Sep 2025- Present

TA Scholarship, Sogang Univ · Sep 2025- Present

Dean's List Award

Academic Excellence Award

Integrated Undergrad-Grad Degree Program Scholarship · Sep 2025, Sogang Univ.

OTHER ACADEMIC EXPERIENCES

SKILLS & Certificates

Programs: Python, STATA, Julia, MATLAB, L^AT_EX

Languages: English (Fluent), Korean (Native)

Test Scores TOEFL: 5.0 (5.5) | Reading 5.5 (5.5) Listening 5.0 (5.5) Speaking 4.5 (4.5) Writing 5.0 (5.0)
GRE: Verbal 158 Quantitative 170 Writing 3.5